



NICE COTE D'AZUR GUIDE

[EXPLORENICECOTEDAZUR.COM](https://explore Nice Cote d'Azur.com)





Here, the sea meets the mountains.

Nice Côte d'Azur is a unique destination spanning coastline, hills, valleys and mountains. From the azure Mediterranean to the peaks of Mercantour, the region displays its contrasts as a single horizon of life. Here, you can savour the gastronomy at the markets, get carried away by the festivals and shows, and share games, leisure activities and emotions throughout the year. Here, light sets the pace of daily life: nearly 300 days of sunshine a year invite you to look up, as Matisse, Chagall and Dufy did, leaving behind a strong artistic heritage.

A secret cove, a hilltop village, a path scented with garrigue, a vibrant square... This mosaic of atmospheres can be enjoyed all year round, in a French-style dolce vita. Easily accessible thanks to its international airport and enhanced by its elegant hotels, Nice Côte d'Azur combines simplicity and refinement.

Welcome to the land of endless possibilities.



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Classified tourism resorts



Towns with the Famille Plus label



Towns offering the my Adventure game
(see p. 43)

EDITORIAL

DEAR VISITORS,

Nestled between the sea and the mountains, the Nice Côte d'Azur Metropolitan area offers an exceptional place to live and visit, where stunning landscapes, a rich heritage and the unique character of our villages come together.

From the Mediterranean to the gateway of the Mercantour National Park, our territory stands out for the variety of experiences it offers. Every town, every valley and every season offers new opportunities to discover the diversity of our landscapes, our traditions and our way of life.

This guide has been designed to accompany you on this exploration. As you turn the pages, you will discover iconic places, itineraries, unmissable events and plenty of ideas for enjoying all the unique charm of our Metropolis.

I wish you a wonderful stay and some amazing discoveries in the heart of the Nice Côte d'Azur Metropolitan Area.

Éric Ciotti
Mayor of Nice
President of the Nice Côte d'Azur
Metropolitan Area



THE COASTAL AREA

Here, blue comes in a thousand shades

The light is dazzling, the blues are endless, and everywhere the horizon beckons. This beauty has always inspired artists, architects, musicians and filmmakers: a living, ever-changing backdrop.

Facing the Mediterranean, each shore offers its own rhythm: a secret cove, a lively beach, a trip out to sea or a dive into the depths. Between sailing, paddleboarding and water skiing, energy alternates with moments of tranquillity facing the open sea.

Day and night, the coastal towns buzz with excitement: gourmet restaurants, museums, shops, festivals and major events enliven the seasons. Here, authenticity is combined with the art of living, while an assumed modernity – sustainable, creative and innovative – nourishes the future.

An elegant and lively coastline, where excellence and simplicity come together naturally.





BEAULIEU-SUR-MER

CAGNES-SUR-MER

CAP D'AIL

NICE

ÈZE

SAINT-JEAN-CAP-FERRAT

SAINT-LAURENT-DU-VAR

VILLEFRANCHE-SUR-MER



BEAULIEU-SUR-MER

Natural elegance / A garden overlooking the sea

Beaulieu-sur-Mer cultivates an exceptional architectural and botanical heritage. The unspoilt coastline, lined with Mediterranean and exotic species, forms a landscape of gardens overlooking the Mediterranean: a natural embodiment of the spirit of the Côte d'Azur.

Water sports and chic leisure activities go hand in hand: luxury shopping along the palm trees, a break on the beach or an evening at the Casino. Throughout the year, the town buzzes with events such as the Beaulieu La Nuit Festival and the Beaulieu Classic Festival.



WORTH SEEING

The Villa Kérylos,
a faithful
reconstruction of a
sumptuous residence
from ancient Greece,
the churches,
the Sancta-Maria
de Olivo Chapel,
the Belle Epoque
heritage, the beaches
and the ports...

Information office Beaulieu-sur-Mer:

38 bd Maréchal Leclerc
06310 Beaulieu-sur-Mer
+33 (0)4 89 22 47 31



www.explorenice-cotedazur.com/beaulieu-sur-mer





CAGNES-SUR-MER

Between art and excitement

Halfway between a coastal town and a hilltop village, its charm lies primarily in Haut-de-Cagnes, a medieval village dominated by the Grimaldi castle museum, which watches over the town. Foujita, Soutine, Klein, Modigliani and Renoir all stayed here, leaving an artistic mark that is still palpable today. By the sea, the Promenade de la Plage stretches along the coastline and is ideal for walks, water sports and relaxation. Cagnes is also a green town: eleven urban parks, including the Parc de la Méditerranée and the Parc des Canebiers, offer freshness and biodiversity in the heart of the town. Here, shopping is an outdoor experience at Shopping Promenade Riviera, France's first open-air shopping centre. When it comes to entertainment, the events calendar never slows down, with the Côte d'Azur racecourse providing some of the highlights.



WORTH SEEING

The Renoir Museum, the Grimaldi Castle Museum and its art collections and exhibitions, the Contemporary Jewellery Museum, the picturesque little fishing port of Cros-de-Cagnes, the Côte d'Azur Racecourse...

Information office Cagnes-sur-Mer:

99 Prom. de la Plage
06800 Cagnes-sur-Mer
+33 (0)4 93 20 61 64



www.explorenice-cotedazur.com/cagnes-sur-mer



CAP D'AIL

A balcony overlooking the Mediterranean

Cap d'Ail enjoys a privileged location between the sea and the mountains, at the gateway to the Principality of Monaco. It is renowned for its splendid late 19th-century villas. A 'classified tourism resort', it has something for everyone: a relaxing stay among coves and gardens, or a sporting getaway along the trails.

The town also loves to showcase art and culture, with a regular programme of events in exceptional settings: Belle Époque villas, gardens, belvederes overlooking the sea... Then there is the call of the quiet life: the seaside path connects coves and belvederes in a setting of pine trees and rocks. A particularly pleasant walk carried by the smell of sea spray and the panoramic view of the Mediterranean.



WORTH SEEING

The Villa les Camélias museum, the Belle Époque villas, the Château des Terrasses, the magnificent panorama from the Tête de Chien trail, the coastal path, the gardens and beaches...

Information office Cap d'Ail:

87 bis av.
du 3 Septembre
06320 Cap d'Ail
+33 (0)4 93 78 02 33



www.explorenice-cotedazur.com/cap-dail





NICE

Between authenticity and urban excitement

Whether you're looking for an urban, cultural, seaside or gourmet break, everything is within easy reach. An international airport connects the city to the world, and around 200 hotels cater to every type of traveller. Seven kilometres of beaches line the Côte d'Azur coastline, while a wide range of activities and major cultural and sporting events punctuate the year. In the heart of Nice, the green corridor extends the promenade into a green oasis and opens onto a lively city centre with numerous shops.

A committed city: Nice pursues a strong policy of sustainable development and environmental protection, designed for everyday use and for welcoming visitors.



WORTH SEEING

Its many museums, architectural heritage, Old Nice with its narrow picturesque streets, colourful markets, gardens and green spaces, panoramic views, and the iconic Promenade des Anglais.



www.explorenice-cotedazur.com/nice



City centre listed as a UNESCO World Heritage Site

On 27 July 2021, UNESCO recognised the Outstanding Universal Value of the architectural, landscape and urban heritage of Nice's city centre. The city is listed as a World Heritage Site under the title 'Nice, Riviera Winter Resort'. The listed area covers 522 hectares, shaped from the second half of the 18th century to the first half of the 20th century by a cosmopolitan winter resort.

It features regulated urban planning, green spaces planted with exotic species, large promenades, including the iconic Promenade des Anglais, and a resort heritage nourished by international influences: villas, hotels, 'palaces', residential buildings, as well as places of worship and social spaces.

NICE
PATRIMOINE
MONDIAL

Nice Information office:

25, avenue Jean Médecin - 06000 Nice
+33 (0)4 92 14 46 14

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ÈZE

The charming hilltop village of the French Riviera.

Perched on a rocky outcrop, Èze is a maze of narrow streets where Michelin-starred restaurants and luxury hotels rub shoulders with boutiques, workshops and galleries run by artists and craftspeople.

At the top of the ancient medieval fortress, the Exotic Garden combines succulent plants and Mediterranean species. At an altitude of 429 metres, the view stretches all the way to Saint-Tropez.

The town stretches across three corniches: from the seaside and its shaded beaches to the Grande Corniche departmental nature park (altitude 700 metres), renowned for its 360° panorama.



WORTH SEEING

The medieval town perched like an eagle's nest above the Mediterranean, the perfumeries, the Baroque church decorated with altarpieces and trompe-l'oeil, the exotic garden...

Information offices

Èze village:

6, avenue du Jardin
Exotique
06360 Èze
+33 (0)4 93 41 26 00

Èze bord de mer :

Av. de la Liberté
06360 Èze
+33 (0)4 93 01 52 00

OUVERT L'ÉTÉ



www.explorenice-cotedazur.com/eze



SAINT-JEAN-CAP-FERRAT

Cap-Ferrat, where time stands still between nature and art de vivre

A former fishing village, Cap-Ferrat became a popular holiday destination at the beginning of the 20th century with the arrival of wealthy families: large estates flourished, including the Villa Ephrussi de Rothschild. Artists found refuge here: Jean Cocteau left his mark on Villa Santo Sospir, and writer Somerset Maugham on Villa La Mauresque.

Around the cape, 8 kilometres of accessible coastal paths form a loop of exceptional viewpoints. Beaches and coves invite tranquility, and all water sports are available à la carte.

The peninsula charms visitors with a varied selection of fine restaurants, quality shops and prestigious hotels, and comes alive with events throughout the year.



WORTH SEEING

The harbour, the 11th-century Saint-Hospice chapel and its bronze Virgin Mary, the Villa Ephrussi de Rothschild and its themed gardens, the shell museum...

Information office Saint-Jean-Cap-Ferrat:

Quai Virgile Allari
06230 Saint-Jean-Cap-Ferrat
+33 (0)4 93 76 08 90



www.explorenice-cotedazur.com/saint-jean-cap-ferrat





SAINT-LAURENT-DU-VAR

The charm of an authentic village and a classified tourism resort

At the gateway to Nice, between the new coastal promenade and the marina, stretches a pedestrianised seafront: a mosaic of shops and restaurants invite you to stroll and enjoy gourmet pleasures, day and night. Just a stone's throw away, Cap3000, voted the best shopping centre in the world, extends the experience. With 2 km of beaches, there is plenty of room for seaside activities and water sports. The highlight of the summer is the Beach Sport Festival, which brings together novices and enthusiasts alike.

The Old Village offers an authentic break: its picturesque streets and Romanesque-Provençal church can be explored on a historical tour.



WORTH SEEING

The marina, the old village, its 11th-century Romanesque church and its connected historical tour, the ornithological area at the mouth of the Var.

**Information offices
Saint-Laurent-du-Var:**

Bord de mer (côté port):
1819 Route du Bord de Mer
06700 Saint-Laurent-du-Var
+33 (0)4 93 31 31 21

**Bord de mer
(côté Cap 3000):**
Prom. Landsberg,
06700 Saint-Laurent-du-Var
+33 (0)4 93 31 31 21

DE MI-JUIN
À MI-SEPTEMBRE



www.explorenice-cotedazur.com/saint-laurent-du-var



WORTH SEEING

VILLEFRANCHE-SUR-MER

A harbour of inspiration and colour

A major port on the French Riviera and a regular stopover for cruise ships, the town opens onto its famous harbour. Lined up between the gentle curve of the shore and the 16th-century citadel, the colourful façades are reflected in the water.

People come to stroll along the quays, lose themselves in the narrow streets of the old village, climb up to the ramparts for the view, then linger on the terraces facing the sea. In the small fishing port, the picturesque atmosphere is evident in the fleet of pleasure boats and pointus: these traditional boats. This theatre of light, between heritage and sea, has long been a place of inspiration for painters and artists.

The harbour, the 16th-century citadel, the Citadel Museum (which brings together the Volti Foundation, the Boumeester-Goetz Collection, and the history museum with the municipal collections), the Royal Port of La Darse, the Saint-Pierre chapel decorated by Jean Cocteau, the Saint-Michel church, the old town, the Rue Obscure...

**Information office
Villefranche-sur-Mer:**

Jardin François Binon
06230 Villefranche-sur-Mer
+33 (0)4 93 01 73 68



www.explorenice-cotedazur.com/villefranche-sur-mer



THE MID COUNTRY

Here, the sea connects the mountains

A stone's throw from the Mediterranean,

villages nestled in greenery or perched on rocks like eagles' nests invite you to take a stroll. Follow charming narrow streets and discover a preserved heritage: old oil mills, weathered façades, fountains and wash houses. And suddenly, around the corner of a chapel, a panoramic view of the valleys, the sea or the mountains opens up.

Bathed in sunshine, this setting brings out the colours. It has captivated the greatest artists; following in their footsteps and searching for the works they left behind delights art lovers.

When the urge to move returns, the hiking trails can be explored on foot or by bike. The steep-sided gorges offer the coolness of canyoning or rafting: a lively way to discover the landscape without disturbing it.





ASPREMONT
BONSON
CARROS
CASTAGNIERS
CHÂTEAUNEUF-VILLEVIEILLE
COLOMARS
DRAP
DURANUS
FALICON
GATTIÈRES
GILETTE
LA GAUDE
LA ROQUETTE-SUR-VAR
LE BROCC
LA TRINITÉ
LEVENS
SAINT-ANDRÉ-DE-LA-ROCHE
SAINT-BLAISE
SAINT-JEANNET
SAINT-MARTIN-DU-VAR
TOURRETTE-LEVENS
UTELLE
VENCE



ASPREMONT

Here, the houses are arranged in concentric circles around a beautiful Gothic church overlooking the Var plain. The climb is challenging, but the reward is immediate: cobbled streets, vaulted passageways, secret flower-filled gardens, cut stone, fountains and wash houses. At the end of the route, your gaze is drawn to the blue ribbon of the Mediterranean.



WORTH SEEING

The Church of St James the Greater (13th and 16th centuries: frescoes, paintings, 18th-century altarpiece, naive statue of the Virgin Mary). The 17th-century Chapel of Saint Claude, built as a votive offering to ward off the plague. Notre-Dame des Salettes Chapel, the Chapel of the White Penitents.



www.explore-nicecotedazur.com/aspremont



BONSON

Perched on the Mont Vial massif, Bonson is a balcony overlooking the Var and Estéron valleys.

At an altitude of 480 metres, built lengthwise,

it gives the impression of a promontory. Its narrow streets lead to breathtaking views and reveal a discreet and precious medieval heritage.

It is nicknamed 'the village of nine chapels': a trail, indicated in front of the town hall, invites you to discover them. On the outskirts of the village lies a remarkable olive grove, a centuries-old legacy of olive cultivation, which gives Bonson a bright, Mediterranean atmosphere.



WORTH SEEING

The Church of Saint-Benoît (1494), which houses an altarpiece by Antoine Bréa; a copy of this work can be admired in its original location, in the Chapel of Saint-Jean-Baptiste. The Chapel of Saint-Hospice, the Chapel of Le Passet and the Chapel of Saint-Antoine.



www.explore-nicecotedazur.com/bonson



WORTH SEEING

The Château de Carros, classified as a natural site and monument of artistic interest, the numerous remains from antiquity, the Middle Ages and modern (11th-18th) and contemporary (19th-20th) periods, and the site of the 'Roche Fendue' (Split Rock).



www.explore-nicecotedazur.com/carros





CASTAGNIERS

The village nestles in the hills overlooking the Var plain. Founded around 1870, it lies in the shadow of Mount Cima (879 m), whose viewpoint offers a view that is not to be missed. Walk among the scrubland and gardens and take in the panoramic views. To the south, terraced fields planted with olive trees punctuate the landscape, like a Mediterranean signature.



WORTH SEEING

The oil mill (still in operation), the 19th-century parish church of Saint-Michel, the Abbey of Notre-Dame de la Paix, the Cistercian convent with its beautiful garden (1928), the chocolate factory, the Croix du Cuore, and the protected site of the Vallon Obscur du Donaré, classified as a Natura 2000 site.



www.explore-nicecotedazur.com/castagniers



WORTH SEEING

The Church of Sainte-Marie de l'Assomption, the ruins of Castelnuovo (formerly Châteauneuf), the Chapel of Saint Joseph, the Rémaurian waterfall, Mount Macaron (discovery trail), the Barre du Midi.



www.explorenice-cotedazur.com/chateauneuf-villevieille





COLOMARS

On a sunny ridge, Colomars is made up of hamlets: Les Cabanes, La Madone, La Sirole on the heights, and La Manda in the hollow of the Var plain. A recent residential village, Colomars invites you to take a stroll among its viewpoints and olive groves. The Pays Niçois caillietier olive is what makes the place famous: its fine flesh and hints of lemon and aniseed produce a golden oil that is sought after by discerning palates.



WORTH SEEING

The Church of Notre-Dame de la Nativité (19th century), St-Roch Chapel in La Sirole (1857). Its valleys, which are home to geological and botanical reserves, are embellished with waterfalls and aqueducts that once supplied ancient oil mills.



www.explore-nicecotedazur.com/colomars

DRAP

At the entrance to the valley, the village is perfect for a stroll: along the banks of the Paillon, Provençal façades, an 18th-century bell tower and the village square reveal themselves. To extend your visit, Drap combines heritage and culture: a performing arts venue, a cultural centre dedicated to exhibitions and a programme of events throughout the year. Enough to spark your curiosity and make you want to come back.



WORTH SEEING

The Church of Saint John the Baptist. Chapel of Saint Catherine of Alexandria. The Chapel of the White Penitents. Sainte Thècle, historic canal. The Tercier Plateau. Genoese oil mill. Gras Cultural Centre. Jean Ferrat Space.



www.explore-nicecotedazur.com/drap



DURANUS

The village stands on a limestone ridge overlooking the Vésubie Valley. Scattered across the hillside, it lies at the heart of unspoilt countryside planted with oak and olive trees. Here, the valleys protect exceptional biological reserves, punctuated by waterfalls and aqueducts. You can stroll along paths and through clearings, discovering water sources and the coolness of the undergrowth. On the outskirts of the village, the spot known as 'Saut des Français' is the perfect vantage point for admiring the valley.



WORTH SEEING

The ruins of Rocca Sparvierra (an ancient 12th-century village), the chapel of St. Eurosie and St. Michel, the Saut des Français viewpoint, the old arsenic mine, and the 19th-century church of Notre-Dame de la Nativité.



www.explore-nicecotedazur.com/duranus



WORTH SEEING

The Church of the Nativity (1624) with its square pyramidal bell tower, the Sainte-Croix Chapel (1619), the St-François Gate, an ancient well, the Fortin (18th century), the Bastide, the Tonduti residence-castle (16th century), the fountain and the Bellevue Square.



www.explore-nicecotedazur.com/falicon





GATTIÈRES

Located beneath the Baous mountain range, surrounded by remarkable landscapes, the old village features medieval streets, bridges, flower-filled squares and a stone fountain in its centre, as well as two wash houses, one in the village and the other near the gardens below.

The unspoilt atmosphere invites you to stroll around and discover views stretching from the sea to the mountains. A few artists' studios complete the walk.

The commune extends to the right bank of the Var, where market gardens, aromatic herbs and olive trees perpetuate the link with the land.



WORTH SEEING

**St Nicolas Church
(17th century)
Notre Dame-du-
Var Chapel
(15th century)
(Gattières les
Plans)**



www.explore-nicecotedazur.com/gattieres

GILETTE

At an altitude of 400 metres, between the Var and Estéron rivers, Gilette is dominated by the ruins of its castle. The village can be explored by wandering through its peaceful, colourful streets. As you climb, the viewpoint and esplanade reveal panoramic views of the village, the mountains, the surrounding rivers... and, on a clear day, as far as the Mediterranean. In the heart of wild and unspoilt natural areas, Gilette cultivates a way of life faithful to authenticity and tradition; the olive tree remains its emblematic treasure.



WORTH SEEING

**The Church of
Saint-Pierre and
the Assumption
(17th century) and
the Chapel of
Saint-Pancrace, the
wash houses and
fountains, the oil
mill, the Museum of
Traditional Crafts
'Lou Ferouil', the
castle visit, the
Artisans' Boutique.**

**Gilette Information
office:**

Mairie - 1 Place du
docteur René Morani
06830 Gilette
+33 (0)4 93 08 57 19



www.explore-nicecotedazur.com/gilette



LA GAUDE

A veritable balcony suspended above the sea, nestled between the coast and the highlands, La Gaude stretches out beneath the Baous mountain range. Carefully restored houses, narrow cobbled streets, sunny squares: stroll around and discover the simple, welcoming setting that charmed Marcel Pagnol for over 30 years. In November, the town comes alive with the 'Jazz sous les Bigaradiers' festival, which brings together international and local artists. On the edge of the Var, the Baronne district is home to a large research centre that extends the village's life into the world of innovation.



WORTH SEEING

The Sainte-Victoire church, the Saint-Ange chapel or white penitents, the fountains, La Coupole...



www.explore-nicecotedazur.com/la-gaude



WORTH SEEING

The Baroque St-Pierre church, the ruins of Castel-Vieil, the 15th-century Notre-Dame Del Bosc Chapel. A 200-year-old Genoese mill, one of the few still operating in the traditional way, managed by an olive-growing cooperative.



www.explorenice-cotedazur.com/la-roquette-sur-var



LE BROC

Perched on a rocky outcrop above the Var and Estéron rivers, the village lies beneath the Chiers mountain. Visitors can stroll through narrow streets lined with old stone houses, clustered around a charming arcaded square. Everywhere, vestiges of the past recall a rich history of culture and heritage. Near the old castle, there is a viewpoint offering a superb panorama: the valley below and, in the distance, the Alps.



WORTH SEEING

The Church of Sainte-Marie-Madeleine (1563), the chapels of Sainte-Marguerite and Saint-Sébastien, and the oil mill.



www.explore-nicecotedazur.com/le-broc



WORTH SEEING

The parish church of Sainte-Trinité, listed as a historic monument, the church of Saint-Grat (1848, Italian Baroque), Notre-Dame-de-Laghet and its small museum of ex-votos presenting one of the richest collections in Provence, the Astrorama...



www.explore-nicecotedazur.com/la-trinite



LEVENS

Perched 600 metres above sea level on a rocky outcrop, this ancient fortified medieval village is best explored at a leisurely pace. Climb the sloping alleyways lined with stone houses, passing under porches and covered passageways. Nearby, the Grand Pré de Levens offers 13 hectares of greenery: a breath of fresh air for relaxation and events throughout the year, including the Horse Festival in July.



WORTH SEEING

The ancient gates of the feudal walls, the house of Marshal André Masséna, the birthplace of François Malausséna, the first French mayor of Nice. The Galerie du Portal, where exhibitions are held, Saint-Antonin Church, the chapels of the Black Penitents and the White Penitents.

Levens Information office:

Place V. Massegli -
Maison du Portal
06670 Levens
+33 (0)9 62 66 85 84



www.explorenice-nicecotedazur.com/levens



SAINT-ANDRÉ-DE-LA-ROCHE

Bordering Nice, the municipality stretches across the hills of Rimiez and Abadie. Discreet hamlets nestle in the greenery, crossed by the Banquière: a tributary of the Paillon which flows into the Baie des Anges. Nicknamed 'Lou pais dei babi' (the land of amphibians), it lends an ear to the croaking of frogs that accompanies summer nights.



WORTH SEEING

The mills, the chapel of Saint-André and Saint-Grat, the cave. The 17th-century Château des Thaon de Revel stands on a rocky outcrop.



www.explorenice-nicecotedazur.com/saint-andre-de-la-roche



SAINT-BLAISE

A road winding through the hills, olive groves glistening in the sunlight: Saint-Blaise appears like a medallion set in the greenery. Surrounding the church with its red-tiled bell tower, the village forms a colourful ensemble where visitors enjoy strolling from square to alleyway. Higher up, the old village and the ruins of the medieval castle (13th century) dominate the site; the paths lead to beautiful views of the valley.



WORTH SEEING

The well-preserved ruins of a castle (13th century), the church (18th century) and the adjoining priory, the oil mill, the bridge, the works of artist Jean-Pierre Augier scattered throughout the village and in the museum gallery, the century-old olive groves, and the Auberge Communale Le Prieure for a gourmet break.



www.explore-nicecotedazur.com/saint-blaise



WORTH SEEING

The hiking trails lead to the Baou de Saint-Jeannet, the Baou de la Gaude, the Gros Chêne, the Castellaras and the dry stone pastoral heritage, the Church of Saint Jean-Baptiste dating from 1666 and the village's four chapels, as well as the vineyards.

SAINT-JEANNET

Nestled at the foot of its Baou hill, this hilltop village exudes Provençal authenticity and offers a unique view stretching across the entire French Riviera. Of medieval origin, its stone houses are grouped together in a rampart around the church, under the watchful eye of an ancient fortified castle perched on the neighbouring hill (not open to visitors) and the ruins of a keep. A mecca for rock climbing, the site offers routes suitable for all levels. The unmissable climb up the Baou de Saint-Jeannet can be tackled via various routes offering breathtaking, dizzying views.

Information office Saint-Jeannet:

Parking René Veyssi
06640 Saint-Jeannet
+33 (0)4 93 59 49 45



www.explorenice-cotedazur.com/saint-jeannet





SAINT-MARTIN-DU-VAR

At the crossroads of the Var, Estéron, Vésubie and Tinée valleys, the town was built on land reclaimed during the embankment of the left bank in the mid-19th century. Today, Saint-Martin-Du-Var is a thriving economic area where people live as much as they work. It offers spectacular views: walks along the hillsides reveal vistas where the Var and Estéron meet, between rivers and open landscapes.

TOURRETTE-LEVENS

Just 15 kilometres from Nice, Tourrette-Levens is a hilltop village that still boasts a tower from its medieval castle. Its commanding position offers visitors panoramic views of the sea and mountains, where nature reveals itself in all its splendour and invites visitors to enjoy numerous hikes. This authentic village, with a focus on art and culture, is also home to three free museums nestled in the heart of the village.



WORTH SEEING

The old village, the two large squares (18th and 19th centuries), the Saint-Roch church and its 17th-century paintings, the Art Deco war memorial, the Romanesque Notre-Dame Del Bosc chapel and its 16th-century fresco.



www.explorenice-cotedazur.com/saint-martin-du-var



WORTH SEEING

The Church of Our Lady of the Assumption, the castle-museum of natural history, the museum of traditional crafts, the museum of prehistory, the square and the chapel of the White Penitents.



www.explorenice-cotedazur.com/tourrette-levens





UTELLE

On a ridge at the confluence of the Var and Vésubie rivers, the village clings to a steep slope where olive trees and low walls punctuate the climb. The old town centre forms a beautiful medieval ensemble: staircase streets and alleys, old stone houses, ancient doors, fountains and pointed arches. A small path circles the village and offers a panoramic view of the peaks of Haute-Vésubie: the light changes throughout the day, revealing unexpected reliefs. For nature lovers, a walk along the GR5 trail allows you to discover the Saint Antoine chapel and a panorama of the Vésubie gorges.



WORTH SEEING

Original trompe l'oeil façades, remarkable sundials, the lintels of several ancient doors, the Saint-Véran church, the oil mill, the Sainte-Croix chapel, the Madone d'Utelle, and the completely renovated Saint Sébastien chapel.



www.explore-nicecotedazur.com/utelle



WORTH SEEING

The Rosary Chapel, designed entirely by Matisse, the smallest cathedral in France dating from the 11th century, the Vence Museum, a mecca for modern and contemporary art, the Gombrowicz museum space in the Villa Alexandrine...



www.explore-nicecotedazur.com/vence



Vence Information office:

Place du Grand Jardin
Villa Alexandrine
06140 Vence
+33 (0)4 93 58 06 38

THE HIGH LAND

Here, the seasons sculpt the peaks

Reaching an altitude of 3,143 m, the summit overlooks magnificent landscapes, shaped by nature over centuries. Villages built on the rock or nestled in the valleys preserve a living heritage, maintained daily by their inhabitants.

In summer, the scenery becomes a playground for adventure: lakes, forests, peaks, and gorges create high-altitude areas to explore. In winter, the ski resorts take over: snow, sunshine, and panoramic views—all forms of winter sports find their place here.

**Year-round, people come for the tranquility,
the crisp air, and the clear horizons.**





MOUNTAIN VILLAGES

Perched on ridges or nestled in valleys, mountain villages tell a thousand-year-old story. Cobbled streets, stone houses, sunny squares: every detail bears witness to a heritage of skills passed down through the generations and preserved to this day. Here, life follows the rhythm of the seasons, surrounded by unspoilt nature and living traditions.

BAIROLS
BELVÉDÈRE
CLANS
ILONSE
ISOLA
LA BOLLÈNE-VÉSUBIE
LA TOUR-SUR-TINÉE
LANTOSQUE
MARIE
RIMPLAS
ROQUEBILLIÈRE
ROUBION
ROURE
SAINT-DALMAS-LE-SELVAGE
SAINT-ÉTIENNE-DE-TINÉE
SAINT-MARTIN-VÉSUBIE
SAINT-SAUVEUR-SUR-TINÉE
TOURNEFORT
VALDEBLORE
VENANSON

MOUNTAIN AND SKI RESORTS

From alpine resorts to Nordic areas, you can enjoy everything from your first tracks to long descents while admiring panoramic views warmed by the winter sun. Families, beginners, experienced skiers: each resort has its own character and events. Whether you're looking for fun, technique or contemplation, it's up to you to choose your pace.



AURON

On its vast domain, skiing takes on a new dimension. With 135 km of slopes, Auron offers the largest alpine domain in the department. From gentle slopes to long runs, you can alternate between pleasure and technique. Throughout the winter, the resort lives to the rhythm of a lively snow front for young and old alike.



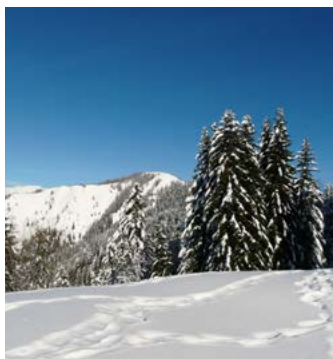
ISOLA 2000

The resort offers 120km of slopes, as well as a snowpark and a boardercross course. Unusual: the summit of Sistron offers a fabulous panorama from the Écrins massif to the Mediterranean Sea, via the Viso and the Argentera massif. Entertainment and events for all, throughout the season.



LA COLMIANE-VALDEBLORE

Here, the mountain is gently divided: 30 km of slopes for beginners and experienced skiers alike, a kindergarten, toboggan run, snowshoeing, ski touring... And for a change of view: the giant zip line, the resort's signature feature, offers a flight over the landscape.



ROUBION

Here, skiing is on a human scale. Catch some altitude with six lifts (including a chairlift) and enjoy over 30 kilometres of downhill skiing through forests and clearings. Then change pace on 12 kilometres of cross-country trails, or go snowshoeing for a gentle stroll in the silence of the mountains. For families, there's a free toboggan run with a conveyor belt, dog sledding and more.

SAINT-DALMAS-LE-SELVAGE

Saint-Dalmas-le-Selvage is a renowned Nordic base camp. Starting from the village, Nordic skiing and snowshoeing trails lead into the tranquillity of snow-covered forests, between clearings and woods.

SAINT-MARTIN-VÉSUBIE

A landmark for Nordic skiing. Head to Boréon, one of the largest centres in the Alpes d'Azur. Set off on a variety of trails and glide between fir trees and clearings, enjoying the tranquillity of winter. Cross-country skiing, snowshoeing, artificial ice climbing.



TURINI CAMP D'ARGENT

Under the bright winter sun, the landscapes offer something for everyone. Carve turns on your skis, set off on snowshoes across the ridges and valleys, and stop to take in the view that will make you want to stay all day.



BAIROLS

Perched at an altitude of 830 metres, Bairols stretches along a rocky ridge, suspended between the sky and the valley. This medieval village, nicknamed the 'village of thousand-year-old stones', invites visitors to contemplate and explore. Cool alleyways, vaulted ceilings, covered passageways, steep staircases... every step reveals a remarkable view of the valley. All around, trails lead off to explore the surrounding ridges and forests.

BELVÉDÈRE

Belvédère overlooks the Vésubie Valley and opens the way to the famous Gordolasque, a land of hiking and alpine excitement. Dominated by the Church of Saint Peter and Saint Paul and its 12th-century bell tower, the village reveals its centuries-old chapels, witnesses to a living history and a strong identity.

Here, pastoralism is a source of wealth: breeders and farmers perpetuate ancestral know-how celebrated during convivial festivals. At the gateway to the Mercantour National Park, it is a privileged starting point for hiking enthusiasts: high-altitude lakes with crystal-clear waters, natural waterfalls, the Nice refuge, and of course, the Vallée des Merveilles.



WORTH SEEING

The church of St. Margaret, patron saint of the village, the inn in an old mill, the gîtes, the circuit of the three chapels, the remains of Queen Jeanne's mill.

Mairie:

+33 (0)4 93 02 90 46



www.explore-nicecotedazur.com/bairols



WORTH SEEING

The façades of the chapels of St-Antoine, Le Planet, St-Roch, St-Blaise and St-Grat in La Gordolasque, the Pénitents Blancs square, the Church of Saint-Pierre et Paul, the Milk Museum, the Gordo cattle farm, and the Belle et Sébastien cabin.

Belvédère Information office:

10 rue du Navel
06450 Belvédère
+33 (0)4 93 03 51 66



www.explore-nicecotedazur.com/belvedere



CLANS

Overlooking the Tinée Valley, Clans hides real treasures behind its stone walls: old mills, fountains, wash houses, drinking troughs, and a large square shaded by plane trees. Visitors linger in the shade of the lime trees, play a game of pétanque on the boules court, and stroll through the peaceful narrow streets.

Nature is never far away: deep forests, trails accessible on foot or by electric bike, and a unique organic swimming lake in the valley. Summer is spent in the great outdoors, relaxing and being active.

ILONSE

Perched at an altitude of 1,250 metres, Ilonse overlooks the Tinée Valley from a rocky outcrop. This medieval village, built on a staircase-like slope, reveals its stone façades, arcaded passageways, magnificent open wash house with columns, and Baroque chapel.

At the top, a small square welcomes walkers with its panoramic terrace. An orientation table reveals the surrounding peaks, inviting visitors to take in the landscape.



WORTH SEEING

Numerous wash houses, chapels, the listed collegiate church in the centre of the village with its incredible frescoes, the Chapel of St John decorated entirely by the artist Moya, and the listed Chapel of St Anthony.

Clans Information office:

Place de la Collégiale
06420 Clans
+33 (0)9 63 66 09 78

OUVERT DE MAI
À SEPTEMBRE



www.explorenice-cotedazur.com/clans



WORTH SEEING

The 13th-century Saint-Michel Church (inside, 15th-century choir, paintings classified as historical monuments), the Saint-Grat Chapel (17th century), and the Saint-Pons, Saint-Maur and Saint-Antoine Chapels.



www.explorenicecotedazur.com/ilonse



ISOLA

Nestled at an altitude of 870 metres, at the confluence of the Tinée and Castiglione rivers, Isola retains the soul of a medieval village. Its inhabitants, proud of their history, see the trompe-l'œil façades — blue, pink, yellow — as an expression of a folk art that is still alive today. Just 15 km away, the Isola 2000 resort takes over, summer and winter alike. With 120 km of slopes and activities for all ages, including fishing, hiking, mini golf and mountain biking, the excitement changes with the seasons but the intensity remains the same.



WORTH SEEING

The Lombard-style Saint-Pierre bell tower, the Saint-Anne Chapel of the Confrérie des Pénitents Blancs, the Saint-Roch Chapel, its fountains, the wash house, the Aquavallée fitness centre and the snow lake.

Isola Information offices:

Isola Village:

11 rue de la Liberté
06420 Isola village
+33 (0)4 22 64 00 04

Station Isola 2000:

Immeuble le Pelevos
Station Isola 2000
06420 Isola
+33 (0)4 93 23 15 15



www.explorenice-cotedazur.com/isola-isola-2000



WORTH SEEING

The Entomology Museum, Saint-Laurent Church, the grain mill and the cultural centre.

Information office Bollène-Vésubie:

2 Place du Général de Gaulle
06450 La Bollène-Vésubie
+33 (0)4 93 03 60 54



www.explorenice-cotedazur.com/la-bollene-vesubie





LA TOUR-SUR-TINÉE

Perched on a ridge, La Tour-sur-Tinée watches over the valley, nestled between wooded peaks and rolling hills. The view stretches far across the landscape, the light settles in, and you understand what ‘panorama’ really means. The heart of the village has retained its medieval soul: cobbled streets with painted façades are connected by a central square. Here, you can take the time to stroll around before setting off on the trails. From the village, there are several hiking trails to choose from, depending on your mood: a leisurely loop or a more challenging hike to neighbouring villages.



WORTH SEEING

The Chapel of Saint-Jean-Baptiste (14th century), the Chapel of the White Penitents (15th century), Saint Martin’s Church (12th century), the house known as ‘des Templiers’ with its mullioned windows (15th century), and the Béal craft centre (former oil and flour mills from the 18th century).



www.explorenice-cotedazur.com/la-tour-sur-tinee



WORTH SEEING

The Church of Saint-Pons, the Chapel of Sainte-Claire (15th century), the Church of Notre-Dame des Anges in Pélasque, Saint-Arnoux Church and the 13th-century ruins of the castle in Loda, Martinet Bridge, Gordolon Fort, Notre-Dame de la Balma Sanctuary, the barns of La Brasque, the ‘louana

de l’éléphant’, Maïris Forest, the hamlets, and Notre-Dame de Lourdes Chapel.



www.explorenicecotedazur.com/lantosque





MARIE

Marie, whose name first appeared in 1066, cultivates a rare authenticity. This medieval village in the Tinée Valley, formerly a stronghold of the Grimaldi family, lives in tune with nature, far from the hustle and bustle. Perched on a rocky outcrop on the mountainside, it offers a 180° panorama sweeping across the valley, from Mont Vial to the heights of Haute-Tinée.

A peaceful stopover, focused on contemplation and the simplicity of true things: footpaths unfold to explore ancient countryside, the forest, the ridges or Marie's cattle farm and its mountain pastures. The Clamia trail offers gravel and mountain bike enthusiasts a variety of routes.



WORTH SEEING

The 16th-century Saint-Pons church houses two paintings by Nice painter Giovanni Rocca dating from 1644, an imposing statue of the Virgin Mary and the baby Jesus, and a 14th-century processional cross.

The feudal gate, the castle, the bread

oven, the oil mill, the Saint-Roch chapel, two wash houses, sculptures by François Fuentes, an artist from the village...



www.explore-nicecotedazur.com/marie



RIMPLAS

Perched on a ridge between Tinée and Val de Blore, Rimplas gently cascades down an alpine landscape. Its staircase-like alleyways wind between pink façades, vaulted passageways and rushing streams. Visitors are surprised by the trompe-l'oeil painted marble walls that lend the place a discreet poetry.

Every turn reveals a fragment of history, every stone seems to hold the memory of a medieval village.



WORTH SEEING

The forts of La Madeleine and La Frassinée, the sculpture gallery of Serge Doglio, an artist from the village.



www.explore-nicecotedazur.com/rimplas



ROQUEBILLIÈRE

At an altitude of 600 metres, Roquebillière lies nestled in the Vésubie valley, at the gateway to the Mercantour National Park. Here, nature invites you to get some fresh air, and village life takes place in the square, at the Tuesday market or at events organised throughout the year.

On the banks of the Vésubie, three biological pools invite you to swim in the heart of nature. A few steps away, the tennis courts are free to use, and the pump track and padel courts are ideal for getting fit. Local associations set the pace of village life and there is no shortage of accommodation.

Seven kilometres away, the Berthemont-les-Bains spa resort, the only one on the Côte d'Azur, offers treatments from April to November: treatments in the morning and relaxation in the afternoon. Sulphurous waters, spa, swimming pool...



WORTH SEEING

The church of St-Michel-de-Gast, listed as a historic monument, the Galerie des Arts Vésubiens, which brings together local artists, and the Fort de Gordolon, part of the Maginot Line in the Alps.

**Information office
Roquebillière:**

26 av Corniglion Molinier
06450 Roquebillière
+33 (0)4 93 03 51 60



www.explorenice-cotedazur.com/roquebilliere



ROUBION

Perched on the side of a cliff, Roubion watches over the valley like a stone sentinel. The village stretches across five hamlets, between meadows and forests, at an altitude of between 1,335 and 1,920 metres. Its steep narrow streets, vaulted passageways and medieval houses create a lively, raw setting full of character. Around a low wall, a breathtaking panorama unfolds. In summer, visitors can enjoy hiking, and in winter, the small alpine ski resort offers 30 km of slopes in a peaceful, family-friendly atmosphere. It is a stop on the legendary Route des Grandes Alpes, between wild nature and stone sculpted by time.



WORTH SEEING

The 12th-century ramparts, the Saint-Sébastien chapel (16th century, listed as a historic monument), the Notre-Dame du Mont Carmel church (18th century), the communal oven, the sundials, the dovecotes and the old barns.

**Information offices
Roubion:**

Village:
Place Récipon
06420 Roubion
+33 (0)4 93 02 10 30

Les Buissets:
Station Les Buissets
06420 Roubion
+33 (0)4 93 02 10 30

OPEN IN WINTER AND
SUMMER DURING THE
SEASON



www.explorenice-cotedazur.com/roubion





ROURE

Facing south, Roure enjoys generous sunshine and a sheltered climate. The purple-hued houses tell a story of farming and pastoral life rooted in the valley. At the top of the village, a place unique in Europe combines nature and creativity: the Marcel Kroenlein Arboretum. Here you can discover mountain trees from all over the world, rare conifers, sculptural maples, bright houseleeks...

The plant species interact with the works of art: a high-altitude garden where every step invites contemplation.

SAINT-DALMAS-LE-SELVAGE

Nestled in the hollow of a mineral cirque, Saint-Dalmas-le-Selvage is the highest commune in the Alpes-Maritimes. A stop on the GR5 and Grande Traversée du Mercantour trails, it cultivates an elegant simplicity.

Its cobbled streets wind between schist facades and sundials, in a silence barely disturbed by the breath of the wind. On the heights, the Route de la Bonette, the highest road in Europe, reveals breathtaking panoramas. Here, marmots, mouflons, chamois and ibex share the landscape.



WORTH SEEING

The listed Saint-Laurent Church (13th-18th century), the Saint-Sébastien Chapel (1510), the ruins of a castle, the charming hamlet of Tiecs and its Sainte-Anne Chapel, the Arboretum.

Roure Information office:

Place Jules Mallet
06420 Roure
+33 (0)4 93 03 41 78

OUVERT



JUILLET / AOÛT

www.explorenice-cotedazur.com/roure



WORTH SEEING

The 16th-century Church, the 15th-century Sainte-Marguerite Chapel, a listed monument, rock climbing, and ice falls in winter.

Information office Saint-Dalmas-le-Selvage:

Maison de Pays
06660 Saint-Dalmas-le-Selvage
+33 (0)4 93 02 46 40



www.explorenice-cotedazur.com/saint-dalmas-le-selvage



SAINT-ÉTIENNE-DE-TINÉE

At the gateway to Mercantour National Park, Saint-Étienne-de-Tinée is a lively crossroads just 7 km from the resort of Auron. Surrounded by peaks over 3,000 metres high, the village charms visitors with its colours: pastel façades, sundials, ancient fountains, decorated chapels and precious frescoes.

Here, you can stroll between museums and small squares, history and modernity. It is both a cultural and mountain destination.



WORTH SEEING

The Church of St-Étienne (rebuilt in the 18th century with its bell tower dating from 1492). The Chapels of the Trinitaires (17th century), St-Sébastien (15th century), St-Michel des pénitents noirs, St-Maur. The Museums of Traditions, Milk and School.

Information offices de Saint-Étienne-de-Tinée:

Place de l'Eglise
06660 Saint-Étienne-de-Tinée - Auron
+33 (0)4 93 02 41 96

Auron
Av. Mahira - Grange Cossa
06660 Saint-Étienne-De-Tinée - Auron
+33 (0)4 93 23 02 66



www.explorenice-cotedazur.com/saint-etienne-de-tinee-auron



SAINT-MARTIN-VÉSUBIE

At an altitude of 975 metres, nestled in the heart of 3,600 hectares of forest, Saint-Martin-Vésubie lies among pine and larch trees at the gateway to the Mercantour National Park. Nicknamed 'the Switzerland of Nice', this medieval village also boasts beautiful 18th and 19th century mansions, standing proudly along the winding paths.

All around, chalets line the forest paths and the hills invite you to go for a walk. As a starting point for hikes in the Mercantour Park, in a setting of remarkable richness, the mountains can be experienced in all their grandeur.



WORTH SEEING

Rue Cagnoli, the Sainte-Anne gate, the parish Church, the Vesubia Mountain Park sports complex, the site of the Madone de Fenestre and its sanctuary (restricted access: contact the Information Office) the Alpha Park to meet the wolves, the Boréon Nordic centre.

Information office Saint-Martin-Vésubie:

5, avenue Kellerman
06450 Saint-Martin-Vésubie
+33 (0)4 93 03 21 28



www.explorenice-cotedazur.com/saint-martin-vesubie





SAINT-SAUVEUR-SUR-TINÉE

Nestled in a bend of the Tinée Valley, Saint-Sauveur-sur-Tinée cultivates a discreet and unique atmosphere. Stroll through the narrow streets with their unpredictable slopes and discover a round fountain, a covered wash house and carved lintels dating from the 16th century. The Baroque church, painted orange-pink, stands guard with its 15th-century Romanesque bell tower. An old bread oven, a flour mill: every detail tells a story of ancient craftsmanship that must be preserved.



WORTH SEEING

The Saint-Michel Church, the Chapels.



www.explorenice-cotedazur.com/saint-sauveur-sur-tinee



TOURNEFORT

Rebuilt after the earthquake of 1887, Tournefort can now be explored in two stages: the current town, scattered across the landscape, and the old hilltop village, which can be reached via a wide staircase. Up there, among the wild grass and ancient stones, the ruins of the castle can be approached via small footpaths. A discreet escape, combining memory, silence and nature at liberty.



WORTH SEEING

Saint-Pierre Church (17th century), the Penitents' Chapel (15th and 16th centuries), the remains of the fortified castle, the vaulted cellars.



www.explorenicecotedazur.com/tournefort



VALDEBLORE

Valdeblore comprises several mountain villages: La Bolline, La Roche, Saint-Dalmas and the hamlet of Mollières, at an altitude of 1,600 metres. The Mercantour National Park provides the backdrop. The La Colmiane resort offers adventure all year round: in summer, there are zip lines, tree climbing courses, donkey rides, paragliding, via ferrata and swimming. In winter, 30 km of slopes welcome all types of skiers. A lively, accessible and generous mountain, where everyone can find their own pace.



WORTH SEEING

Religious buildings, typical narrow streets and numerous fountains. The giant zip line (the longest in France) at La Colmiane.

Information office
Valdeblore La Colmiane:

Route du télésiège
La Colmiane
06420 Valdeblore
+33 (0)4 93 23 25 90



www.explorenice-cotedazur.com/valdeblore-la-colmiane



VENANSON

At an altitude of 1,164 metres, Venanson overlooks the valley from its rocky peak. Surrounded by an impressive mountain cirque, the village reveals its charming squares, ancient fountains and narrow streets leading to the cliff and its spectacular views. Up there, the view stretches out, and encounters with deer, chamois, hares, golden eagles, griffon vultures and even bearded vultures are sometimes unexpected... All around, the trails lead off into a striking landscape, between wild silence and nature in motion. The Venanson botanical trail allows you to explore the richness of the local flora.



WORTH SEEING

The parish Church of Saint-Michel (17th century), the Sainte-Claire Chapel (15th century) and its frescoes, classified as a Historic Monument, masterpieces by the Piedmontese painter Giovanni Baleison, the 18th-century fountains

and wash house, and the remains of the ancient ramparts.



www.explorenice-cotedazur.com/venanson

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zou.maregionsud.fr



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<https://www.ter.sncf.com/sud-provence-alpes-cote-d-azur/tarifs-cartes/bons-plans/pass-sudazur-explore>



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www.cpzou.fr



THE « TRAIN DES MERVEILLES »

This tourist train offers a journey of discovery through the Paillon and Roya-Bévéra valleys and the Mercantour National Park, home to the Vallée des Merveilles. A tour guide provides commentary on the route and recounts the traditions, culture and landscape of the villages along the way (in French/English).

Every day from June to September inclusive. Departure from Nice-Ville at 9.15am



+33 (0)800 11 40 23



<https://www.ter.sncf.com/sud-provence-alpes-cote-d-azur/decouvrir/trains-touristiques/train-merveilles>



Never leave luggage unattended and report any suspicious behaviour or objects.

Be very vigilant on public transport and at popular tourist sites.

Whether at the seaside or in the mountains, don't forget to check the weather forecast before you set off, always take appropriate equipment for your activity and leave your itinerary with someone else.



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let's respect living things!
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